



Qualitative Methods: Narrative EDPS 935 – Fall 2024

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Narrative Research

This is an approach to qualitative research that is both a product and a method. It is a study of stories or narrative or descriptions of a series of events that accounts for human experiences

- (Pinnegar & Daynes, 2007).

The focus of narrative inquiry is not only valorizing individuals' experience but is also an exploration of the social, cultural, familial, linguistic, and institutional narratives within which individuals' experiences were, and are, constituted, shaped, expressed and enacted.

- (Clandinin, 2023)

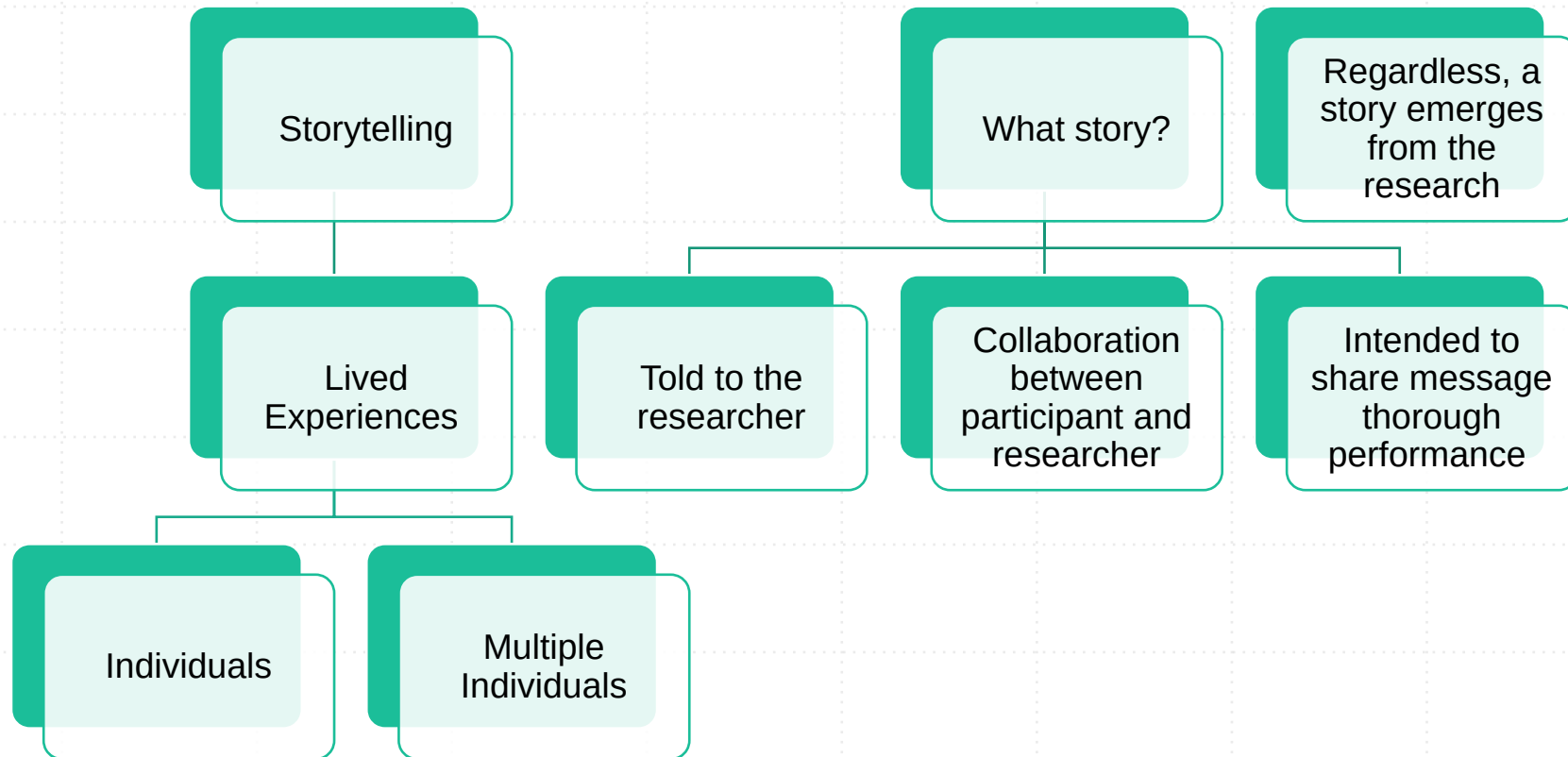


What is Narrative Research

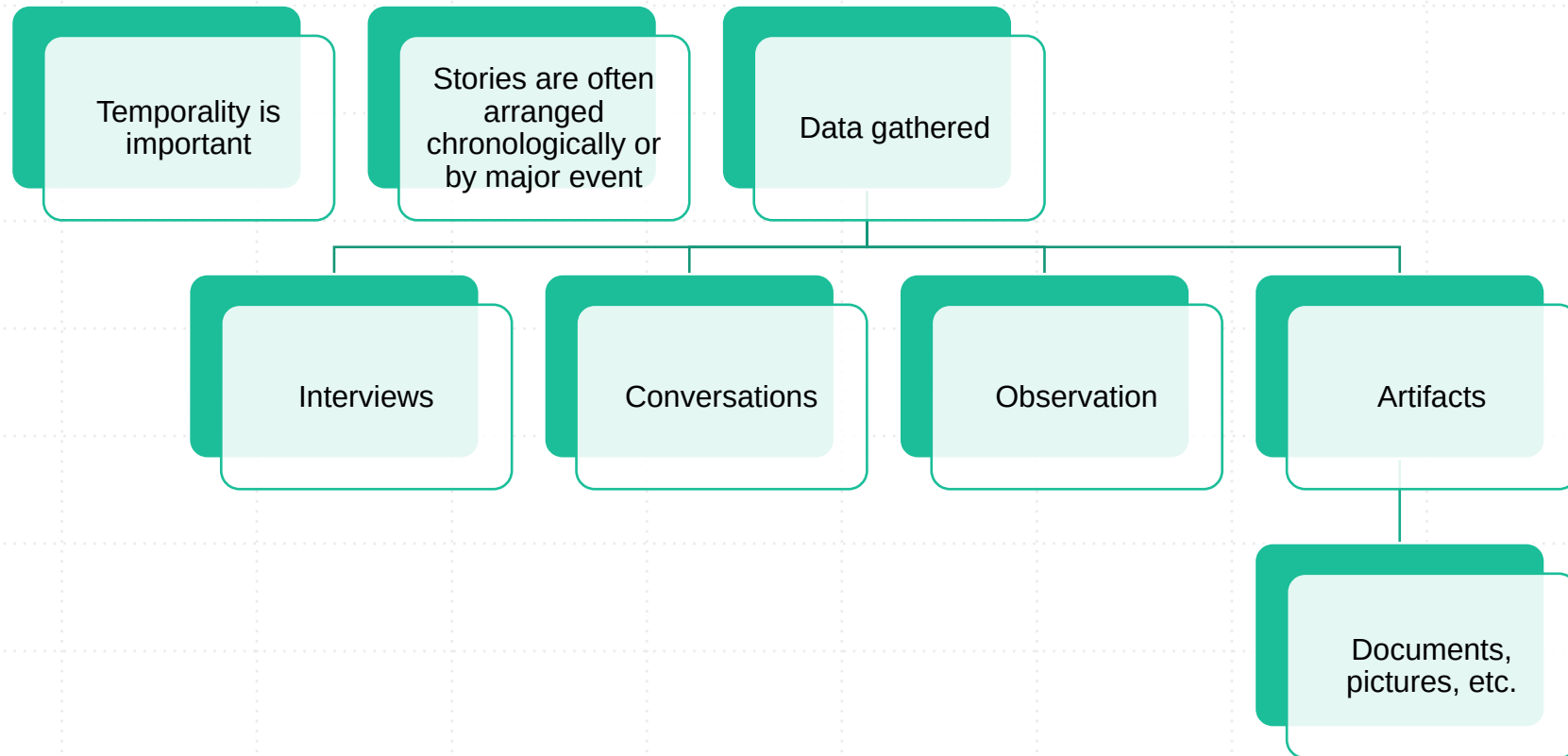
- Exploring the life of one or more individuals
- Takes many forms
- Rooted in the practices of many different cultures, social disciplines, and the study of humanity
- The narrative could focus on the phenomenon (one person's experience) or the methods used in a study (how are stories told)
- Giving an account of events or actions
- Collection of stories

• Creswell and Poth, 2025

Defining Characteristics



Defining Characteristics Continued



Analysis



What was said?

Thematical



Nature of how the story was told

Structural



Who is the intended audience

Dialogic/performance



Visual analysis



Focus

Values, plot, significance, character mapping, and time (Daiute, 2018)



Storytelling Parallels

Plot

Transitions/turning points

Tensions

Major events

Consequences

Patterns

- Similarities, differences, change, or coherence (Daiute, 2018)

Sub-Approaches of Narrative Inquiry



Types/Forms

Biography, autobiography, autoethnography, art-based, life history, life story, lived experience



Variations in data analysis

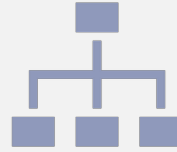
Thematic analysis, structural analysis, performance analysis



Interpretive frameworks

Critical race theory, feminist theory, queer theory, disability theory

Sub- Approaches: Types



Life History: A narrative that explores the entire life of an individual, often longitudinal.

Example: Documenting the life of a political leader, covering their childhood, career, and eventual rise to leadership.



Life Story: A personal recounting of significant events in one's life, often centered around specific episodes rather than the entire lifespan.

Example: A participant recounting the pivotal moment of starting their own business or moving to a new country.



Lived Experience: A narrative that captures a specific personal experience or series of events from one or more individuals, focusing on how those events are experienced or perceived. This can be done for a single individual or a group.

Example: A study of how a community experienced a natural disaster, with each person contributing their perspective on what happened.

Sub-Approaches: Types (continued)



Biography: The study of an individual's life, documented by another person (the researcher), often drawing from interviews, historical records, and other sources.

Example: A researcher writing about the life of an artist, using archival documents, interviews, and letters to reconstruct the story.



Autobiography: When the researcher is also the subject, studying and writing about their own life.

Example: A scholar reflecting on their personal educational journey to draw insights about their teaching practice.



Autoethnography: A form of autobiography that connects personal experiences with broader cultural, political, or social contexts.

Example: A researcher recounting their experience of growing up in a marginalized community and connecting it to broader themes of inequality and resilience.



Arts-Based Inquiry:
Incorporates creative forms of writing, visuals, or performances as part of the narrative research.

Example: A researcher working with Native American students, guiding them in creating digital stories using video, images, and voiceovers to narrate their cultural experiences. T.

Sub-Approaches: Types (Examples)

Autobiography Narrative Inquiry: “TRANSFORMING OUR PRAXIS THROUGH CROSS-CULTURAL PERSPECTIVES IN PEDAGOGY” (2023)

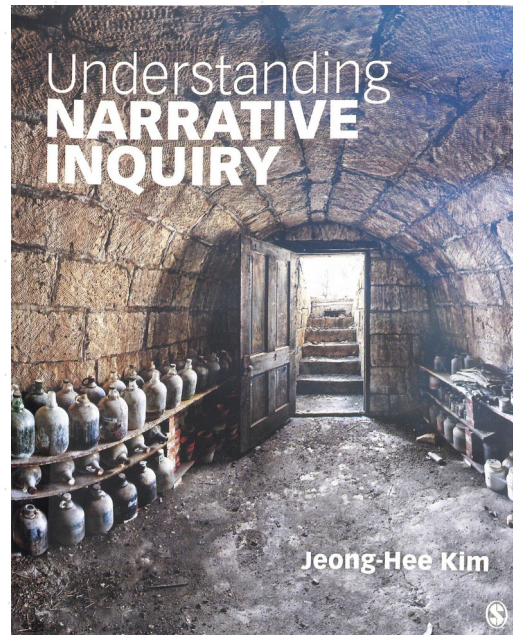
-Andrea Flanagan-Borquez, Universidad de Valparaiso, Chile

-Kiyomi Sanchez-Suzuki Colegrove, Texas State University, United States

Art-based Narrative Inquiry: “Storytelling and Digital Media Lab, & Rigolet Inuit Community Government.

(2013). Storytelling in a digital age: digital storytelling as an emerging narrative method for preserving and promoting indigenous oral wisdom”.

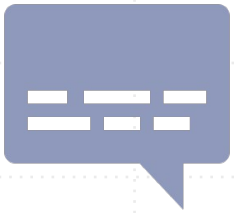
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Arts-Based Narrative Inquiry

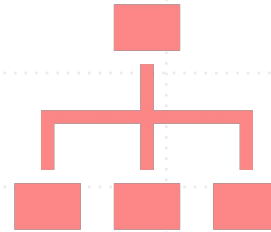
Some of you might feel strange or even uncomfortable about writing creative nonfiction. or poetry as part of your research product. "Can this really be research?" you wonder. You also wonder if your advisor would approve of such arts-based work for your dissertation. (Kim, 2015, 136)

Sub-Approaches: Analysis



Thematic Analysis: This approach involves extracting themes that emerge from the stories. The researcher focuses on identifying common themes or patterns across narratives (Polkinghorne, 1995; Riessman, 2008).

Example: The researcher identifies recurring themes, such as resilience or identity, from participants' stories.



Structural Analysis: In this type, the analysis focuses on the way the story is structured and told. It considers the narrative form, such as whether it is framed as a comedy, tragedy, or other literary genres (Riessman, 2008).

Example: Examining how a participant frames their experience as a tragedy or a romance, which shifts the meaning of the narrative.

Sub-Approaches: Analysis (continued)



Storytelling Mode or Plotline Analysis:

Polkinghorne (1995) emphasizes this form, where the researcher shapes the narrative based on a plotline or a literary approach to storytelling.

Example: The researcher organizes the narrative around a central plot, focusing on how events unfold according to a storyline.



Dialogic or Performance Analysis: This focuses on how the story is co-constructed interactively between the researcher and participant, examining how it is performed and what message it is intended to convey (Riessman, 2008).

Example: Analyzing how the participant's story is shaped by the interaction with the researcher, highlighting the collaborative nature of storytelling.

“What is Critical Whiteness Doing in OUR Nice Field like Critical Race Theory?”



Narrative study reintroducing Black Imagination



Set in a large, Western state, urban university



Teacher candidates teaching in urban schools with larger populations of Black and Brown students



Employed Consensual Qualitative Research (CQR)



Five researchers



16 participants – 15 identified as white, all pre-service teachers



Biographical narrative study



CRT and CWS Coding Tables

Critical Race Theory	Critical Whiteness Studies
Lack of Understanding Contemporary Racism	Colorblindness
Unintentional Racism	Exertions of Whiteness
Majoritarian Discourse	White Diss-course



Four Common Themes

Teacher candidates were emotionally (dis)invested in racial justice

Students recognized that they are white, but did not push themselves beyond that acknowledgement

Students resonated in “white guilt”

There was an overall engagement and endorsement of hegemonic whiteness



Pushing Back on Never Experiencing racism, privilege, or oppression.

Interviewer: The school where are right now—it's very diverse.

Katie: No, I really haven't. I think that we were actually just talking about that at our site school, with diversity. I don't think I've seen any racism, but I think I've seen some ignorance or some, like, glossing over. Like, not even that. More like just assuming that everybody is the same and not recognizing the student's differences.

Interviewer: Not realizing that there is another perspective to an event or situation?

Kate: Ya. Exactly, so I think that is a for of it, but it's more just the ignorance of it and the misunderstanding I guess.



Conclusions

Many of our white teacher candidates expressed how learning about race and racism reinforced their normative beliefs of how race and racism is a non-white problem.

Whiteness is an active investment.

The participants refused to critically understand how their white imagination produces a perverted sense of race understanding.

This white imagination racially codified words and attempted to equate them to terminologies like white supremacy, whiteness, and racism.

This sharply contrasts the Black imagination, where the latter terms are employed instead of codified.

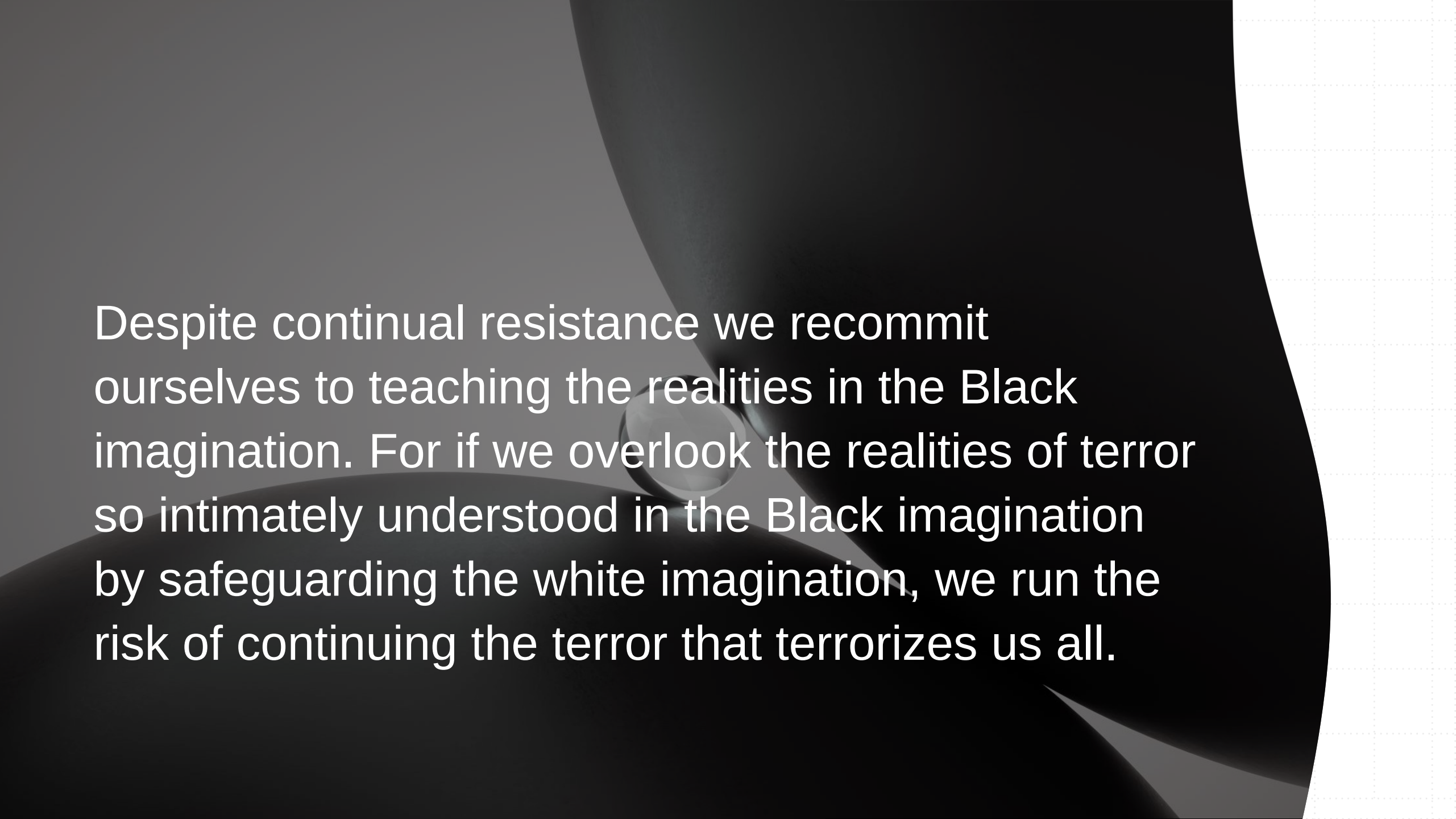


Action Items

Include CWS and CRT readings so that white teacher candidates can identify and understand how the existence of the white imagination impacts their understanding of race dynamics.

Students should deconstruct how white communities are normalized as good communities.

Embed racial justice throughout the entire program even if it begins with putting racial justice in its philosophy.



Despite continual resistance we recommit ourselves to teaching the realities in the Black imagination. For if we overlook the realities of terror so intimately understood in the Black imagination by safeguarding the white imagination, we run the risk of continuing the terror that terrorizes us all.



Within and beyond a grow-your-own- teacher program

Longitudinal narrative study focusing on sustaining and developing Latina teachers in white-normative spaces

Rural, agricultural K-12 school district in Kansas

One primary researcher/mentor/colleague/friend

Seven culturally and linguistically diverse (CLD) Latina educator/participants/co-researchers

Utilized Chicana feminist epistemologies to privilege Latina teacher narratives

Lived experience narrative study



Narratives as Mirrors

- Using their own narratives as mirrors, participants reflected upon who they were as CLD, first-generation, non-traditional college students, their prior experiences in the *grow-your-own-teacher* program, and their current realities as CLD teachers of CLD students in white normative public schools.



Findings & Interpretations

1) Drawing on Identity Backgrounds

- Being able to acknowledge and deconstruct the complex realities presented by their cultural and linguistic diversity within the safety of the grant based program proved vital to their success.





2) Cultural Wealth and Experience as Means for Caring

- The Latinas learned to use their various forms of cultural wealth as tools to enact critical care pedagogies for effective teaching.

3) Transformative Resistance to Whiteness

- Each participant developed their own professional identities as CLD teachers which guided their approaches to transformative resistance with the often toxic environments of their schools.





4) Sustainment of/for CLD Community

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- As pre-service and now in-service teachers, they drew strength and sustainment from the learning *community*. Engagement in reflective and critical dialogs spurred healing and steeled resolve.



Discussions & Considerations for Practice

Potential of grow-your-own-teacher models as well as the critical, yet often overlooked, contextualize process and informed pedagogies useful for effective CLD teacher preparation and development.

CLD teachers are a vital resources in schools

Author argues that because CLD pre-service/in-services teacher biographies are *different* (relative to the historically white, monolingual teaching force), the ways in which programs recruit, prepare and mentor them must be different.

Living in the Space between Participant and Researcher as a Narrative Inquirer: Examining Ethnic Identity of Chinese Canadian Students as Conflicting Stories to Live By



Nuts & Bolts

How ethnic identity is shaped for first-generation Chinese Canadian students.

Canadian, urban middle school in a multicultural neighborhood.

Longitudinal, narrative inquiry with an ethnographic bent.

Took place between 2001 – 2003.

The purpose of the study is to understand the **complexities of ethnic identity formation** for immigrant students, particularly how conflicting expectations from different spheres (home, school, peers) shape their lived experiences.



Three Main Themes

1

Conflicting
Influences on
Ethnic Identity

2

Parental
Expectations vs.
Peer Integration

3

Teacher
Involvement and
Misunderstanding

Action Items



SUPPORT CULTURAL
INTEGRATION



TEACHER TRAINING ON
MULTICULTURALISM



LANGUAGE
MAINTENANCE SUPPORT

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